lines of a nation-state. The literature shows that for non-Christian non-European countries, the path to being treated as a ‘civilised nation’ was obviously more arduous, and therefore they had to effect a fundamental change in their systems to be accepted into this elite European/Western club of nations. The following are a few relevant excerpts from a seminal work on the topic, ‘The Standard of “Civilisation” in International Society’ by scholar Gerrit Gong,[8] which supports the position enumerated above:

> Paralleling the expansion of the European international system, the international society of European states—those countries which had European civilization in common—also began to extend its boundaries. Interaction with non-Christian and non-European countries underscored the international society’s need for a universally acceptable identity. Thus, in extending its domain, the international society which had earlier identified itself with Christendom and then with Europe came gradually to characterize itself as ‘civilized’.
>
> According to the logic of a standard of ‘civilization’, the nineteenth-century international lawyers (then referred to as publicists) divided the countries of the world into ‘civilized’, barbarous, and savage spheres ....
>
> …. Indeed, some non-European countries had to learn the hard way. Until they fulfilled the standard’s requirements, these non-European countries remained outside the law’s pale and protection.[9]

It is true that every nation or culture had its own definitions of who was civilised and who was the savage; the difference, however, was that Europe sought to universalise its definitions whereas others used it primarily to provide or restrict access to their societies and territories. That the distinction struck by the Christian White European was based on his obsession with race and ethnicity, especially his superiority thereof—which he believed as an anthropological fact—is evident from the historical treatment of ‘inferior’ races. The view is summed up by James Lorimer, a Scottish advocate, professor of public law and an authority on international law in the nineteenth century[10]:‘No modern contribution to science seems destined to influence international politics and jurisprudence to so great an extent as that which is known as ethnology, or the science of races.’